BandSix

TOEFL iBT® PREP · 2026 FORMAT · B2–C1

TEACHER LESSON PLANS

Writing

17 day plans · 3-hour classes · 30–45 minutes teacher-led

Each plan gives you a minute-by-minute run sheet for the class, what to present, a board plan, likely errors, concept-check questions, support and stretch tasks, an exit ticket and the student work to collect.

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Days marked “ETS lesson” match a free ETS TOEFL iBT® lesson plan: use your own copy of that plan in class.

HOW TO USE THESE PLANS

Writing: 17 classes at a glance

Every class lasts **3 hours**. You lead the first part (a 10-minute warm-up and **30–45 minutes** of presentation); students then work on the BandSix day for about two hours while you circulate, and the class ends with a 10-minute exit ticket. Times in the run sheet are a guide: the platform minutes come from the BandSix day itself. Strategy and tutorial stages are covered in your presentation, so students only skim them on the platform. A day unlocks only when every activity of the previous day is checked, so anything not finished in class becomes homework.

DAY	TITLE	TASK FOCUS	ETS LESSON TO USE IN CLASS
1	**Inside the new Writing section**	All Writing tasks	Writing Lesson 1 · Writing Introduction
2	**Build a Sentence I: English word order**	Build a Sentence	–
3	**Build a Sentence II: questions**	Build a Sentence	–
4	**Build a Sentence III: embedded questions**	Build a Sentence	Writing Lesson 2 · Combining Sentences
5	**Build a Sentence IV: relative clauses and passives**	Build a Sentence	–
6	**Build a Sentence V: reported speech, modals and speed**	Build a Sentence	–
7	**Write an Email I: structure and tone**	Write an Email	Writing Lesson 3 · Write an Email Sample Response
8	**Write an Email II: problems and complaints**	Write an Email	–
9	**Write an Email III: requests, recommendations and invitations**	Write an Email	–
10	**Write an Email IV: seven minutes, two times**	Write an Email	–
11	**Academic Discussion I: reading the task and taking a position**	Write for an Academic Discussion	Writing Lesson 4 · Write for an Academic Discussion
12	**Academic Discussion II: developing support**	Write for an Academic Discussion	–
13	**Academic Discussion III: adding something new**	Write for an Academic Discussion	Writing Lesson 5 · Write for an Academic Discussion Sample Response
14	**Academic Discussion IV: range and precision**	Write for an Academic Discussion	–
15	**Editing: the errors raters notice**	Write Email · Discussion	–
16	**Full Writing section mock**	Full Writing section	–
17	**Review and personal study plan**	All Writing tasks	–

The 3-hour pattern

PHASE	TIME	YOUR ROLE
Warm-up	10 min	A quick activity that activates the day's skill. Every plan suggests one.
Teacher-led	30–45 min	Present the strategy with the board plan, model it, and check understanding with the concept-check questions. On ETS lesson days, teach from the ETS plan and use BandSix for follow-up.
Platform	≈ 2 h	Students complete the BandSix day. Circulate, look at the checklist at the bottom of each day, give one-to-one feedback, and watch for the errors listed in the plan.
Wrap-up	10 min	Exit ticket and a preview of the next day. Remind students to send writing and recordings to Drive.

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ETS LESSON · ALL WRITING TASKS

Day 1 · Inside the new Writing section

By the end of the class, students can describe the three Writing tasks, measure your typing speed and try a first set of Build a Sentence items.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Typing race: everyone types the same 30-word sentence on their phone or laptop; compare times. Ask how long 100 words would take them.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Writing Lesson 1 · Writing Introduction. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: What the section looks like.	35
0:45–0:50	**Platform**	Typing speed check (Toolkit)	5
0:50–1:05	**Platform**	Build a Sentence: first try (Guided practice)	15
1:05–1:20	**Platform**	Build a Sentence: ten more (Guided practice)	15
1:20–1:45	**Platform**	First email (Guided practice)	25
1:45–2:00	**Platform**	Grammar check: the basics raters notice (Toolkit)	15
2:00–2:05	**Platform**	Reflection (Reflection)	5
2:05–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	45
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** typing speed and the Build a Sentence item that was hardest. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Writing Lesson 1 (Writing Introduction) as your core lesson.
- Present the three tasks (Build a Sentence, Write an Email in 7 minutes, Academic Discussion in 10 minutes) and what raters look for: task completion, development, language.
- Explain why typing speed matters on this test and introduce the 60-second typing check.
- Model one Build a Sentence item on the board, including an extra tile.

Board plan

Build a Sentence · Email (7 min) · Discussion (10 min, 100+ words)
Task · Development · Language
No spell-check!

Check understanding

Q: How long is the Academic Discussion task?
A: 10 minutes, at least 100 words.
Q: Does the test check your spelling for you?
A: No.

Watch for

- Very slow typing on phones; recommend a laptop or keyboard where possible.
- Assuming spelling will be corrected automatically.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker typists do the typing check twice and record the better score.

Stretch: Strong students write the first email in 6 minutes.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.
- Typing speed result (in the progress report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.
- Write three sentences using a structure from today's lesson about your own life.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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BUILD A SENTENCE

Day 2 · Build a Sentence I: English word order

By the end of the class, students can place subjects, verbs, objects, adjectives and adverbs in the standard English order.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Jumbled sentence on strips: groups rebuild 'I usually take the bus to campus' and 'The room isn't big enough for everyone'.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Build a Sentence; The backbone of every sentence.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten sentences (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:35	**Platform**	Extended practice: twenty sentences (Guided practice)	25
1:35–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review: a short email (Guided practice)	25
2:00–2:12	**Platform**	Grammar check: adjective and adverb order (Toolkit)	12
2:12–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	38
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** correct two wrong sentences you write on the board. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Find the verb first, put the subject before it, then object, place, time.
- Frequency adverbs go before the main verb but after 'be'.
- Adjective order: opinion, size, age, shape, colour, origin, material.
- 'Enough' goes after adjectives and before nouns; pronoun objects go inside phrasal verbs.

Board plan

S + V + O + place + time
usually take · is always
big enough / enough chairs
fill it out

Check understanding

Q: 'big enough' or 'enough big'?
A: big enough.
Q: Where does 'always' go with 'be'?
A: After it: She is always late.

Watch for

- Spanish word order: adjectives after nouns, 'enough big', 'I take usually'.
- 'Fill out it' instead of 'fill it out'.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students first identify and colour the verb tile in each item.

Stretch: Strong students write three sentences with three adjectives in the right order.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Describe three objects in your room using two or more adjectives in the correct order.
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.

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BUILD A SENTENCE

Day 3 · Build a Sentence II: questions

By the end of the class, students can build direct questions with the correct auxiliary and word order, including subject questions without “do”.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	'Find someone who…' with questions students must form correctly (How long have you…? What kind of music do you…?).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Question word + auxiliary + subject + verb.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten questions (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:35	**Platform**	Extended practice: twenty questions (Guided practice)	25
1:35–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review: discussion post (Guided practice)	25
2:00–2:12	**Platform**	Grammar check: question forms (Toolkit)	12
2:12–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	38
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write three questions to ask a new classmate, checking the auxiliary. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Question word + auxiliary + subject + verb; present the pattern table.
- After do/does/did, use the base form (does it start).
- Subject questions take no do (Who gave the speech?).
- Watch for an extra tile, often an extra do or does.

Board plan

Wh- + aux + S + V
does it start (not starts)
Who called? (no did)

Check understanding

Q: Correct: 'Where she lives?'
A: Where does she live?
Q: 'Who ___ the final speech?' gave or did give?
A: gave.

Watch for

- 'What time it starts?' with no auxiliary.
- 'Who did call you?' in subject questions.

Differentiation

Support: Students say each question aloud before submitting.

Stretch: Strong students write five subject questions and five object questions about a news story.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Write five questions you would ask a new classmate. Check the auxiliary in each one.
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.

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ETS LESSON · BUILD A SENTENCE

Day 4 · Build a Sentence III: embedded questions

By the end of the class, students can build polite indirect questions and reported questions, where the word order changes back to statement order.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students ask you direct questions (Where is the bathroom?); you answer only if they make them polite and embedded (Could you tell me where…?).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Writing Lesson 2 · Combining Sentences. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: The most tested structure.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten sentences (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:15	**Platform**	Exit check (Exit check)	5
1:15–1:40	**Platform**	Extended practice: twenty embedded questions (Guided practice)	25
1:40–2:05	**Platform**	Mixed review: a polite request email (Guided practice)	25
2:05–2:17	**Platform**	Grammar check: embedded questions (Toolkit)	12
2:17–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	33
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** rewrite three direct questions as embedded questions. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Writing Lesson 2 (Combining Sentences) as your core lesson.
- Embedded questions use statement order and no do/does/did.
- Show the direct vs. embedded table and the openers (Do you know, Can you tell me, I wonder, She asked).
- Punctuation belongs to the opener: Do you know…? vs I wonder… .

Board plan

Can you tell me where the station IS?
how much it COSTS (no does)
if / whether for yes-no

Check understanding

Q: Which is correct: 'Do you know where does she live?' or 'Do you know where she lives?'
A: Do you know where she lives?
Q: What word do we use to embed a yes/no question?
A: if or whether.

Watch for

- 'Can you tell me where is the station?' (the most common error).
- Keeping 'does' inside the embedded question.

Differentiation

Support: Give a colour code: opener (blue), question word (red), subject (green), verb (black).

Stretch: Strong students turn five direct questions from an interview into reported questions.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Turn five direct questions from your day into polite embedded questions (Could you tell me…?).
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.

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BUILD A SENTENCE

Day 5 · Build a Sentence IV: relative clauses and passives

By the end of the class, students can build sentences with who/which/that/whose/where clauses and passive verbs.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	'Who am I?': describe a famous person or place using relative clauses (She's the singer who..., It's the city where...).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Longer noun phrases.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Ten sentences (Guided practice)	25
1:10–1:35	**Platform**	Extended practice: twenty sentences (Guided practice)	25
1:35–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review: discussion post (Guided practice)	25
2:00–2:12	**Platform**	Grammar check: relative clauses and passives (Toolkit)	12
2:12–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	38
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** join two sentences with a relative clause and write one passive sentence. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Relative clauses: who (people), which/that (things), whose (possession), where (places), and object clauses with no pronoun.
- Keep the relative clause directly after its noun; find the main verb of the whole sentence.
- Passives: be + past participle (was built, will be announced, is being repaired).
- Model one long noun phrase item step by step.

Board plan

who · which/that · whose · where
the bus I take
be + past participle: was built · is being repaired

Check understanding

Q: 'the student ___ bag is on the chair': who or whose?
A: whose.
Q: Is 'The road is repairing' correct?
A: No: The road is being repaired.

Watch for

- Adding an extra pronoun (the book that I bought it).
- Passive without be (The house built in 1950).

Differentiation

Support: Students underline the main verb before placing the relative clause.

Stretch: Strong students describe their city in five sentences using all four relative pronouns.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Describe three people you know with a relative clause (my cousin, who lives in Tarija, ...).
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.

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BUILD A SENTENCE

Day 6 · Build a Sentence V: reported speech, modals and speed

By the end of the class, students can build sentences with reported speech, modal verbs and conditionals, and complete a timed set of ten.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students report what their partner said a minute ago (She told me to..., He asked if...).	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Three more patterns.	35
0:45–0:55	**Platform**	Timed set: ten sentences in five minutes (Timed task)	10
0:55–0:58	**Platform**	Typing check 2 (Toolkit)	3
0:58–1:08	**Platform**	Review (Guided practice)	10
1:08–1:33	**Platform**	Extended practice: two timed sets (Guided practice)	25
1:33–1:58	**Platform**	Mixed review: email (Guided practice)	25
1:58–2:10	**Platform**	Grammar check: conditionals and reported speech (Toolkit)	12
2:10–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	40
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** the structure each student still finds difficult, with one example of their own. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Reported commands (tell/ask + object + to), reported questions (if/whether + statement order).
- Modals and conditionals (second and third) and so + adjective + that.
- Target 30 seconds per item; place a best guess after one minute.
- Run the timed set with a visible timer and debrief the slowest items.

Board plan

told me TO rest · asked IF I had
If I had..., I would... · If I had had..., I would have...
so steep that

Check understanding

Q: 'She ___ me to rest': said or told?
A: told.
Q: Which is correct: 'If I would have time' or 'If I had time'?
A: If I had time.

Watch for

- 'She said me' (say does not take a person object).
- Mixing 'would' into the if-clause.

Differentiation

Support: Allow 7 minutes instead of 5 for the first timed set.

Stretch: Strong students do both extra sets in 4 minutes each.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.
- Typing speed result (in the progress report).

Daily exposure (homework)

- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.
- Write three sentences using a structure from today's lesson about your own life.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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ETS LESSON · WRITE AN EMAIL

Day 7 · Write an Email I: structure and tone

By the end of the class, students can organize an email around the three task points, with a purpose sentence, clear paragraphs and the right level of formality.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show two emails asking for the same thing, one too direct and one polite. Students list what changes.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Writing Lesson 3 · Write an Email Sample Response. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Write an Email; A structure you can use every time; Analyze a model.	35
0:45–1:05	**Platform**	Your turn (Timed task)	20
1:05–1:45	**Platform**	Extended practice: two more emails (Timed task)	40
1:45–2:00	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:00–2:15	**Platform**	Phrase work: formal and informal (Toolkit)	15
2:15–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	35
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write only a purpose sentence for a new email task. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Writing Lesson 3 (Write an Email Sample Response) as your core lesson.
- Teach the structure: greeting, purpose sentence, one short paragraph per bullet, closing with a next step, sign-off.
- Teach polite requests and the 'too direct → polite' table.
- Analyze the platform model: label purpose, point paragraphs and the request.

Board plan

Greeting · Purpose · Point 1 · Point 2 · Point 3 · Closing · Sign-off
1 min plan · 5 min write · 1 min check

Check understanding

Q: How many paragraphs should cover the bullets?
A: One per bullet, three in total.
Q: Polite version of 'Send me the form'?
A: Could you please send me the form?

Watch for

- Missing one of the three bullets.
- Spanish-style openings ('I write you for…') and over-long greetings.

Differentiation

Support: Give a fill-in email frame for the first attempt.

Stretch: Strong students write the email in 6 minutes and add one specific detail per paragraph.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Rewrite one real message you sent this week in polite, formal English.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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WRITE AN EMAIL

Day 8 · Write an Email II: problems and complaints

By the end of the class, students can describe a problem clearly and politely, and propose or request a specific solution.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Role-play a complaint at a phone shop, first angrily, then politely. Students note the phrases that worked better.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Firm, clear and polite.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Two emails (Timed task)	30
1:15–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two complaint emails (Timed task)	40
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Phrase work: complaints that work (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** one specific detail and one polite request for a new complaint scenario. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Teach the complaint moves: state the problem neutrally, give specific details, explain the effect, request a solution, end positively.
- Facts persuade more than emotion; strong emotion lowers the tone score.
- If the task asks for praise, make it sincere and specific.
- Model with the LanguageHub email.

Board plan

Problem (neutral) → details (date, number) → effect → request → positive close

Check understanding

Q: What makes a complaint credible?
A: Specific details: dates, numbers, names.
Q: Is 'This is ridiculous' a good sentence for this task?
A: No, the tone is too strong.

Watch for

- Angry or sarcastic tone.
- Vague requests (Do something) instead of specific actions.

Differentiation

Support: Students choose request phrases from a printed list.

Stretch: Strong students rewrite a rude complaint into a polite one.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Collect five polite request phrases in your phrase bank and use two of them in a real email or message this week.
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read. Typing speed matters on this test.

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WRITE AN EMAIL

Day 9 · Write an Email III: requests, recommendations and invitations

By the end of the class, students can write emails that recommend, invite or propose, with reasons and practical details the reader can act on.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students recommend a place in Santa Cruz to a foreign visitor in 30 seconds each, with a reason.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Make it easy to say yes.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Two emails (Timed task)	30
1:15–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two more emails (Timed task)	40
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:25	**Platform**	Phrase work: recommending and inviting (Toolkit)	15
2:25–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	25
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** an invitation sentence with time and place. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Make it easy to say yes: recommendations, invitations and proposals need reasons and practical details.
- Present the useful language table (I'd highly recommend…, Would you be interested in…, What if we…).
- Every bullet needs a reason and one concrete detail.
- Match tone to reader: friends vs. professors.

Board plan

Recommend + because
Invite + time + place
Propose + benefit
one detail per paragraph

Check understanding

Q: What two things should a recommendation include?
A: The recommendation and a reason.
Q: 'It's worth ___ (visit)': which form?
A: visiting.

Watch for

- Recommendations without reasons.
- Mixing informal and formal register in one email.

Differentiation

Support: Give a list of formal and informal openings and closings.

Stretch: Strong students write the same invitation twice, once to a friend and once to a professor.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Write a real recommendation for a place in your city in five sentences, as if to a foreign visitor.
- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read.

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WRITE AN EMAIL

Day 10 · Write an Email IV: seven minutes, two times

By the end of the class, students can complete two full emails within the 7-minute limit and score them with the rubric.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show a 7-minute timer and ask students how they will divide the time; elicit the 1–5–1 plan.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: The 1–5–1 plan.	35
0:45–1:15	**Platform**	Two timed emails (Timed task)	30
1:15–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two more timed emails (Timed task)	40
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:20	**Platform**	Self-check: your email habits (Toolkit)	10
2:20–2:28	**Platform**	Reflection (Reflection)	8
2:28–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	22
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** lowest rubric criterion and one action to improve it. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Teach the 1–5–1 plan: one minute to plan details, five to write, one to check.
- Run two timed emails under test conditions.
- Students score both emails with the rubric and compare with Day 1.
- Conference briefly with students whose Task score is under 4.

Board plan

1 min plan · 5 min write · 1 min check:
3 points? tenses? articles? -s?

Check understanding

Q: What do you check in the last minute?
A: All three points, tenses, articles, -s endings.
Q: What do you decide in the first minute?
A: One detail for each point.

Watch for

- Running out of time before the third bullet.
- Skipping the final check.

Differentiation

Support: Weaker students get 8 minutes for the first email.

Stretch: Strong students do both emails in 6 minutes.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

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ETS LESSON · WRITE FOR AN ACADEMIC DISCUSSION

Day 11 · Academic Discussion I: reading the task and taking a position

By the end of the class, students can understand the professor's question, notice what classmates have already said, and state a clear position in your first sentence.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show a professor's question and two classmates' posts. Students summarize each classmate in three words.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Writing Lesson 4 · Write for an Academic Discussion. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Tutorial: Write for an Academic Discussion; Read like a participant.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Your first discussion post (Timed task)	25
1:10–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two more discussion posts (Timed task)	45
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:20	**Platform**	Language check: opinion language (Toolkit)	10
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** write only a first sentence for a new discussion question. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Writing Lesson 4 (Write for an Academic Discussion) as your core lesson.
- Read the professor's final question twice: your first sentence must answer it.
- Summarize each classmate in three words, then choose a side with a different reason.
- Teach the four-part structure: position, reason, example, link to a classmate.

Board plan

2 min read/plan · 7 write · 1 check
Position → Reason → Example → Classmate link

Check understanding

Q: Where does your position go?
A: In the first sentence.
Q: Can you agree with a classmate?
A: Yes, but your reason must add something new.

Watch for

- Long introductions that delay the position.
- Repeating a classmate's idea in other words.

Differentiation

Support: Give a four-sentence frame with sentence starters.

Stretch: Strong students aim for 140 words with two classmate references.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read.
- Read a comment section or forum discussion in English (Reddit, a news site). Pick one comment and write a two-sentence reply that adds a new idea.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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WRITE FOR AN ACADEMIC DISCUSSION

Day 12 · Academic Discussion II: developing support

By the end of the class, students can develop one reason fully with an example and an explanation of why it matters, instead of listing several weak reasons.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show a 'list' paragraph (three reasons in one line each). Students vote: is it convincing? Why not?	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Depth beats length.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Discussion post (Timed task)	25
1:10–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two more discussion posts (Timed task)	45
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:20	**Platform**	Language check: developing support (Toolkit)	10
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** one R-E-C chain on any opinion. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Depth beats length: develop one or two reasons with the R-E-C chain (reason, example, consequence).
- Show weak vs. developed versions of the same idea.
- Present kinds of examples: personal, someone you know, a place, a hypothetical, a general fact.
- Warn against invented statistics.

Board plan

R-E-C: Reason → Example → Consequence (This matters because…)

Check understanding

Q: What is the C in R-E-C?
A: Consequence: why it matters.
Q: Is 'Many studies show 87%…' a good example if you invented it?
A: No.

Watch for

- Three undeveloped reasons in a list.
- Invented precise numbers that sound false.

Differentiation

Support: Students write the R-E-C chain as three separate sentences first.

Stretch: Strong students add a short concession before their conclusion.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Pick any opinion you hold. Write one R-E-C chain (reason, example, consequence) in three sentences.
- Read a comment section or forum discussion in English (Reddit, a news site). Pick one comment and write a two-sentence reply that adds a new idea.

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ETS LESSON · WRITE FOR AN ACADEMIC DISCUSSION

Day 13 · Academic Discussion III: adding something new

By the end of the class, students can contribute an idea that is different from your classmates' posts, while referring to them naturally.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Show one discussion and ask: which group of people did nobody mention? Brainstorm in pairs.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	**ETS lesson:** Writing Lesson 5 · Write for an Academic Discussion Sample Response. Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Four ways to contribute.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	Discussion post (Timed task)	25
1:10–1:55	**Platform**	Extended practice: two posts that add something new (Timed task)	45
1:55–2:10	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:10–2:20	**Platform**	Language check: contributing new ideas (Toolkit)	10
2:20–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	30
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** name the strategy used in today's post. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Follow ETS Writing Lesson 5 (Academic Discussion Sample Response) as your core lesson.
- Present four ways to contribute: different reason, middle position, a group nobody mentioned, respond to an argument.
- Refer to a classmate in one sentence, then move to your own idea.
- Analyze the remote work model's middle position.

Board plan

Different reason · Middle position · Forgotten group · Respond & extend

Check understanding

Q: What is a 'forgotten group' contribution?
A: Discussing people neither classmate mentioned.
Q: How much of the post should be about the classmates?
A: About one sentence; the rest is your idea.

Watch for

- Posts that are mostly summary of classmates.
- 'I agree with Ana because she is right.'

Differentiation

Support: Give opening phrases for each of the four strategies.

Stretch: Strong students write two different contributions to the same discussion.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- For any debate topic, list three groups of people affected. Your new idea often comes from the group nobody mentions.
- Read a comment section or forum discussion in English (Reddit, a news site). Pick one comment and write a two-sentence reply that adds a new idea.

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WRITE FOR AN ACADEMIC DISCUSSION

Day 14 · Academic Discussion IV: range and precision

By the end of the class, students can upgrade simple sentences with complex structures, precise vocabulary and hedging, so that your language score rises.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Upgrade game: show 'This is very bad for students'. Teams compete to write the most precise academic version.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Sentence upgrades.	35
0:45–0:53	**Platform**	Choose the stronger sentence (Guided practice)	8
0:53–1:13	**Platform**	Discussion post (Timed task)	20
1:13–1:58	**Platform**	Extended practice: two posts with upgraded language (Timed task)	45
1:58–2:13	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:13–2:23	**Platform**	Language check: precision (Toolkit)	10
2:23–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	27
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** upgrade two simple sentences. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Sentence upgrades: cause clauses, concession, precise verb phrases, academic noun phrases, second conditional, nominalization.
- The 'avoid / use instead' table (very good → beneficial; get → gain).
- Hedging for academic tone (may, tend to, often).
- Students plan to use one concession, one hedge and one academic phrase per post.

Board plan

Although… · may/tend to · one of the main drawbacks · have an impact on · If… had…, would…

Check understanding

Q: Correct: 'Although it is expensive, but it works.'
A: Although it is expensive, it works.
Q: More academic than 'get experience'?
A: gain experience.

Watch for

- Overusing 'I think' in every sentence.
- Upgraded words used incorrectly (impact in, discuss about).

Differentiation

Support: Give a short bank of eight upgrades to choose from.

Stretch: Strong students rewrite a Day 11 post using five upgrades.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Take a paragraph you wrote this week and upgrade three sentences using the table above.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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WRITE EMAIL · DISCUSSION

Day 15 · Editing: the errors raters notice

By the end of the class, students can find and fix the most common grammar and vocabulary errors of non-native writers in one minute of checking.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Error auction: show ten sentences, some correct. Teams 'buy' the ones they think are correct.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Your one-minute checklist.	35
0:45–0:57	**Platform**	Find the error (Guided practice)	12
0:57–1:17	**Platform**	Timed post + edit (Timed task)	20
1:17–1:57	**Platform**	Extended practice: one email and one post, then edit (Timed task)	40
1:57–2:12	**Platform**	Mixed review: Build a Sentence (Guided practice)	15
2:12–2:22	**Platform**	Editing practice: correct the sentence (Toolkit)	10
2:22–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	28
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** three personal errors added to the error log. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Present the one-minute editing checklist: agreement, articles, uncountable nouns, run-ons, prepositions, word form, false friends, missing subject.
- Focus on Spanish-speaker errors: missing 'it', actually/currently, assist/attend, depend of.
- Teach students to start a personal error log.
- Model editing a post in exactly two minutes.

Board plan

Agreement · Articles · Uncountables · Run-ons · Prepositions · Word form · False friends · It is...

Check understanding

Q: Correct: 'The number of students are growing.'
A: The number of students is growing.
Q: What does 'actually' mean in English?
A: In fact (not currently).

Watch for

- 'Is important to...', 'informations', 'depend of', 'actually' meaning currently.
- Comma splices joining two sentences.

Differentiation

Support: Students check only three error types they choose from their log.

Stretch: Strong students edit a classmate's post and explain each change.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Start an error log: write every error your teacher or the checklist finds, with the corrected version. Review it before each writing task.

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FULL WRITING SECTION

Day 16 · Full Writing section mock

By the end of the class, students can complete all three Writing tasks under test timing: ten sentences, one email in 7 minutes and one discussion post in 10 minutes.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Two-minute calm: explain the order and timing. Timers start before reading each task.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Test conditions.	35
0:45–0:51	**Platform**	Part 1 · Build a Sentence (Timed task)	6
0:51–0:59	**Platform**	Part 2 · Write an Email (Timed task)	8
0:59–1:10	**Platform**	Part 3 · Academic Discussion (Timed task)	11
1:10–1:12	**Platform**	Typing check 3 (Toolkit)	2
1:12–1:52	**Platform**	Second full set (Timed task)	40
1:52–1:58	**Platform**	Reflection (Reflection)	6
1:58–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	52
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** which part felt most rushed and the rubric scores for both texts. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Brief instructions only: Writing is not adaptive; complete all three parts without pausing.
- Run the full section under test timing.
- Students score with the rubrics and compare with Days 10 and 11.
- Collect the writing: students send both texts to their Writing portfolio.

Board plan

Build a Sentence 6 min · Email 7 min · Discussion 10 min
No models until the end

Check understanding

Q: Is the Writing section adaptive?
A: No, everyone gets the same tasks.
Q: When can you look at the model answers?
A: After finishing all three parts.

Watch for

- Students reading model answers before finishing all parts.
- Typing speed limiting the discussion length.

Differentiation

Support: Give weaker typists 12 minutes for the discussion in the second set.

Stretch: Strong students do the second full set with exact test timing.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.
- Typing speed result (in the progress report).

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ALL WRITING TASKS

Day 17 · Review and personal study plan

By the end of the class, students can review your error log and rubric scores, rewrite one response, and plan your writing practice until test day.

Run sheet · 3-hour class

TIME	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	MIN
0:00–0:10	**Warm-up**	Students open their error log and choose their three most frequent errors.	10
0:10–0:45	**Teacher-led**	Present the strategy (see **Teach this**). On screen with the class: Rewrite to improve.	35
0:45–1:10	**Platform**	One more of each (Timed task)	25
1:10–1:50	**Platform**	Rewrite and final practice (Timed task)	40
1:50–2:05	**Platform**	Your plan to test day (Reflection)	15
2:05–2:50	**Platform**	Buffer: students finish any unchecked activity, read every explanation and send recordings or writing to Drive. Use this time for one-to-one feedback.	45
2:50–3:00	**Wrap-up**	**Exit ticket:** students read their writing plan to a partner. Preview the next day.	10

Teach this (30–45 min)

- Show how to use rubric data: lowest criterion → days to repeat.
- Teach rewriting with a model as the fastest way to improve.
- Students rewrite their weakest response, then do the final set.
- Plan to test day: timed email and discussion frequency, error log review.

Board plan

Task/Contribution → Days 7, 11, 13 · Support → 12 · Language → 14–15 · Build a Sentence → 2–6

Check understanding

Q: Your Support score is lowest. Which day do you repeat?
A: Day 12.
Q: How often should you do a timed discussion before the test?
A: At least twice a week.

Watch for

- Rewrites that only fix spelling.
- Plans without timed practice.

Differentiation

Support: Give a rewrite checklist (position, R-E-C, classmate link, three error checks).

Stretch: Strong students rewrite two responses and compare rubric scores.

Collect

- Writing: students press Copy & send to my portfolio; the texts are added to their Writing portfolio in Drive.

Daily exposure (homework)

- Type 10 minutes in English every day: a journal entry, a message, or a summary of something you read.
- Read a comment section or forum discussion in English (Reddit, a news site). Pick one comment and write a two-sentence reply that adds a new idea.
- Read one model response aloud and copy one useful phrase into your phrase bank.

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